were exiled, one was dead. All had risen against him, whether periodically or persistently; all had failed. The exile, meanwhile, the refugee, had clawed his way back to the thrones of Kabul and Delhi. But now, even Humayun's abundant fortune had run out. Seventeen days after his fall, the emperor died.

. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun (Humayun-nama)*, trans. Annette S. Beveridge (The Asiatic Society, 1902).

. Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), trans. Henry Beveridge. vol. 1 (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017).

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat, or Private Memoirs of Moghul Emperor Humayun by Jouher*, trans. Major Charles Stewart (Oriental Translation Fund, 1832).

. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*.

. Afzal Husain, *The Nobility under Akbar and Jahangir: A Study of Family Groups* (Manohar Publishers, 1999). Abul Fazl brings Bairam Khan into the narrative during Humayun's conquest of Champaner fort in Gujarat in 1535 – sometimes considered Humayun's greatest show of military skill and audacity. He climbed up the fort's high walls with a few hundred men and took it by surprise as much as by force.

. The story goes that Bairam Khan was on the road with Abul Qasim, a man 'remarkable for the beauty of his person', when they were stopped by one of Sher Shah's noblemen, who thought, reasonably enough, that the strapping Abul Qasim must be the man his king had wanted to recruit. Though Bairam yelled out who he was, the gallant Abul Qasim would have none of it; he was killed and Bairam escaped. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*. It is an example of the treacherous currents that flowed between the Mughal princes, their courtiers and their thrones that this agitated Uzbek was a retainer of Askari's, sent to spy on Humayun. Instead, and luckily for the latter, he gave the game away.

. Ibid.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Ibid.

. Sultan Begum would form a far closer bond with Akbar than his uncle, so much so that chroniclers of Akbar's life, including even Abul Fazl, speak of her with approval.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Ibid.

. Ibid.

. According to Abul Fazl, Babur 'was much pleased' with the invention.

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*.

. The founder of Shah Tahmasp's Safavid dynasty, Shah Ismail, also founded a cadre of devoted followers called the Qizilbash, 'redheads' – 'a name given to them because they wore a distinctive turban with a red baton and twelve folds that symbolized the Imams of Twelver Shi'ism' (Stephen F. Dale, *The Muslim Empires of the Ottomans, Safavids, and Mughals* [Cambridge University Press, 2010]). Thus, the modern historian Azfar Moin has argued that the crown Shah Tahmasp forced on Humayun's head was not so much an emblem of Shiism but rather of the shah's own Safavid dynasty, and that this ceremony in the shah's court was not so much an induction into a rival sect but rather a literal 'uncrowning' of Humayun, by which Shah Tahmasp made the exiled emperor his 'disciple and slave' (Azfar Moin, *The Millennial Sovereign: Sacred Kingship & Sainthood in Islam* [Columbia University Press, 2012]). More on this later.

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*.